

Rock Solid is the Energy. Say It. Deliver It.

Visual reference cards from the Tuesday 12 May session led by director Corie Dawson. Use alongside the Session 1–3 toolkits. Print, pin to your wall, or keep on your desk.

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Print and pin. Read every morning.

What “rock solid” actually means

It's not arm-waving energy. It's visible certainty — built one delivered promise at a time.

ROCK SOLID =

Saying something + Doing exactly that

ROCK SOLID IS NOT

LOUDNESS

Talking faster, louder, or with more exclamation marks.

CHARISMA

Being naturally extroverted or smooth-talking.

BLUFFING

Pretending to know an answer you don't have.

PERFORMING

Acting confident. The customer can smell it.

SELLING HARDER

Pressuring the prospect with techniques.

ROCK SOLID IS

CERTAINTY

The customer can feel you know what you're saying is going to happen.

PRECISION

When you say 3:30, you call at 3:30. Not 3:32.

PREPARATION

You never open your mouth without having triple-checked the figure.

FOLLOW-THROUGH

Every promise made is a promise delivered. No exceptions.

WALK-AWAY

Willing to lose the deal rather than break the promise.

THE TEST

When you say something to a prospect — does your voice carry certainty, or lift at the end like a question? If it lifts, that's the work.

The “12 months is too long” objection

Common when a prospect has been burned by a previous agency. The fix is the 6+12 structure — 6 months first, then a fresh 12-month contract at month six.

THE SCENARIO

Prospect tells you they'd be willing to sign for six months, but won't commit to 12 because they've been burned. A flat 6-month contract doesn't give SEO the runway to compound. So how do you bridge?

1

ACKNOWLEDGE THE PAIN

“Totally understand. We’ve had clients exactly like you who’d been burned by people who didn’t know what they were doing. That’s why we exist.”

WHY: Rock solid doesn't argue with the prospect's history. It validates it, then redirects.

↓

2

OFFER THE 6 + 12 STRUCTURE

“Here’s the deal — you sign 6 months upfront. If we haven’t delivered by month six, you walk, no questions. If we have, you sign a fresh 12-month contract at month six to keep going. Total = 18 months only if it’s working.”

WHY: Prospect gets real protection (a true exit at month six). We get the runway to compound (the 12-month follow-on, only if we’ve earned it).

↓

3

GET THE VERBAL COMMIT BEFORE LEAVING THE TABLE

“If I can do a 6-month start that rolls into a 12-month contract at month six, are you telling me you’ll sign the paperwork today?”

WHY: Never ferry messages back to the office. Pin the verbal close before you go anywhere.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Never bring negotiations back to the office unless you’ve secured the verbal close at the table. If they won't commit verbally to a yes, the offer is meaningless.

The “I’m not signing today” diagnostic

Four steps from objection to close (or clean walk-away). Drill the language until it's automatic.

1

MATCH THE ENERGY

“Perfect — I wouldn’t expect you to sign today.”

Resets the dynamic. You’re not begging. You’re calm. The prospect didn’t expect that.

2

GET A NUMBER OUT OF 10

“Just out of interest — out of 10, where are you sitting on what we’ve covered today?”

A 10 means sold. A 9 means almost. A 7 means there’s a real objection hidden. Forces specificity.

3

SURFACE THE REAL REASON

“7 — wow, I’ve really stuffed up. What’s the main reason? I’m somewhat disappointed in myself — what have I done wrong?”

Slight self-blame opens the door. The prospect now feels safe revealing the real issue.

4

ISOLATE THE VARIABLE

“All things aside — let’s just focus on price. If I can get you down to \$X, do you think that meets your budget?”

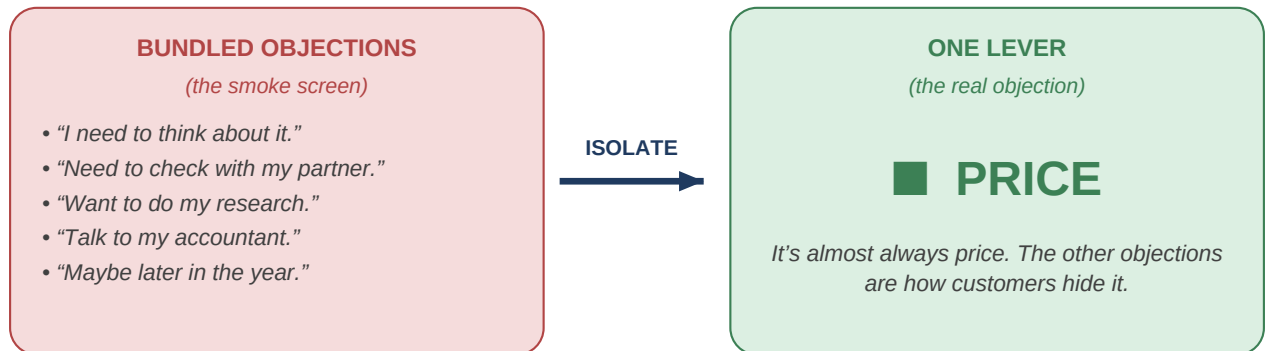
Separates the one solvable lever from the smoke. Almost always price. See Page 5.

TRANSLATION TIP

“I need to do my due diligence.” → Translates to “I have a price objection.” Every time. Don’t fall for the smoke — run the diagnostic anyway.

Isolate the variable

Once you know it's price, separate price from everything else. Don't let the prospect bundle objections to hide.



THE ISOLATION SCRIPT

"All things aside — let's just focus on price."

"If I can get you down to \$650, do you think that meets your budget, assuming the rest of your due diligence works out?"

If yes → you have a deal contingent only on price. If no → keep isolating. There's another objection underneath. Find it.

WHY ISOLATION WORKS

- Removes the prospect's ability to hide behind vague "I need to think."
- Anchors the negotiation on ONE solvable variable.
- Commits them to a yes on every other dimension — so when price resolves, the deal closes automatically.
- Mirrors how negotiation experts operate: never negotiate the bundle. Always one lever at a time.

QUOTE

"It's always the price. Always. They'll have you thinking otherwise — that's the genius of how the customer works." — Corie

The hard close with a deadline

Once price is isolated and agreed, lock the timeline. Make YOU the one with the deadline — not the prospect.

THE SCRIPT

“Let me speak to my manager. If we do the deal on Friday, \$650. If we can’t do it on Friday, the price is off the table. Sound fair?”

TRANSFERS URGENCY

The clock now runs on the prospect, not you. They have to act by Friday or lose the price.

SIGNALS AUTHORISATION

“Let me speak to my manager” positions you as having approval pending. That reads as rock solid, not desperate.

DRAWS THE LINE

If they don’t answer Friday, you walk. Real prospects come back. Time-wasters don’t. Either way, you win.

IF FRIDAY COMES AND THEY GHOST

Send ONE short message: “As discussed, Friday was the deadline. The \$650 price is closed. If you do want to come on board, please give me a call — but I can’t honour that price anymore. Wish you well.”

Then you’re done. Real prospects come back. Time-wasters never do.

THE PRINCIPLE

Rock-solid energy means the rep holds the deadline. Soft energy means the customer holds it. Hold yours.

Burn the boats

Public commitment is how Sun Tzu's armies fought. It's also how rock-solid reps build their reputation.

THE PRINCIPLE

"I burn my boats. I make a decision and I own it. If I intend to survive — cut my way through the enemy. The price of going back is higher than the price of going through."

THE MECHANIC

When you want to ensure you do something — tell everyone publicly so you can't back out. Public commitment removes the easy exit. The decision becomes binding.

APPLY THIS WEEK

- **Tell your manager your weekly target out loud.**
Burn the boat. Now you can't back-fill an excuse later.
- **When you commit to a follow-up time, treat it as a hard contract.**
Say 3:30 → call at 3:30. Not 3:31. The compounding matters.
- **When a prospect asks when you'll call back, name an exact day and time.**
Friday 11am. Then call Friday 11am. Their trust calibrates to your precision.
- **Announce your big goal to the team early.**
Long before the work is done. The announcement is part of how it gets done.

REMEMBER

Your word is the most valuable asset you carry. Every time you say something and deliver it, the value compounds. Every time you say something and don't — it depreciates.

Sparring vs drilling — why your hours don't add up

The 10,000-hour rule applies to sales. Most reps are at 1–2%, and almost all of those hours are sparring. The drilling is missing.

SPARRING

the fun part

WHAT IT IS

Actual customer calls. Real pitches. Live application.

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

Adrenaline. Stakes. Performance. Outcomes.

WHAT IT PRODUCES

Wins, losses, and a vague sense of having “done the work.”

THE TRAP

It's thrilling, so you assume it's building skill. Mostly, you're just running the moves you already have.

DRILLING

the boring foundation

WHAT IT IS

Practising scripts. Role-playing objections. Saying the same line 10 times until the tone is right.

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

Repetitive. Slow. Slightly embarrassing.

WHAT IT PRODUCES

New moves. Reflexive language. Confidence in unfamiliar situations.

THE LEVERAGE

Drilling is how every world-class operator builds their edge. Sparring is how they test it. You need both.

DRILL THIS WEEK

Pick one script from this toolkit (the diagnostic, isolation, hard-close). Practise it out loud with a colleague 10 times this week. Cringe through it. Drill the boring part. That's what produces rock-solid energy when it matters.

Daily mindset card

Read every morning before your first call. Print this page. Pin it to your monitor.

TODAY'S MANTRA

Say it. Deliver it.

CERTAINTY

Your voice should NOT lift at the end. Statements end down. Hold the line.

PRECISION

When you say 3:30, you call at 3:30. Not 3:32. Daily precision compounds into rock solid.

COMMIT

Get the verbal yes BEFORE bringing anything back to the office. "If I can do X, are you signing today?"

ISOLATE

It's always price. Don't fall for due-diligence smoke. Surface the real number.

WALK

If they miss the deadline, the deal is off. Wish them well. Move on. Rock solid means you're willing to walk.

Rock solid is built one delivered promise at a time.

— Corie Dawson